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Cross-Commodity Outlook

Bullish gold and silver; ongoing ME escalation to continue before eventual 4Q26 de-escalation

CITI'S TAKE

As we look back on the summer and forward into year-end and 2027, we wanted to provide a brief and refreshed commodities outlook and highlight some of the other work we have done over the summer that may not have gotten the same exposure. Overall we are bullish metals into year-end, particularly gold and silver, as we expect them to be relatively resilient to rising energy price scenarios from here (more so gold and silver than copper and aluminium, explaining our relative preference), and very bullish in the Strait of Hormuz reopening scenario (possible through a number of paths that make this the central scenario in our view). In energy, we see near-term escalation in the Middle East being bullish energy but ultimately assume SoH reopening during 4Q26.

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See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

Executive summary, central scenario price forecasts & summer highlights

As we start to look back on the summer and into year-end and 2027, we wanted to provide a brief and refreshed commodities outlook and highlight some of the other work we have done over the summer that may not have gotten the same exposure. Commodities have rallied 33% (BCOM TR) year-to-date, led by Energy +77%, Ags +22% (El Nino fears, large summer rally), and Metals +6% (with industrial metals outperforming precious metals with copper/aluminium +10–15%).

We are bullish metals into year-end, particularly gold and silver, as we expect them to be relatively resilient to rising energy price scenarios from here (more so gold and silver than copper and aluminium, explaining our relative preference), and very bullish in the SoH reopening scenario (possible through a number of paths that make this the central scenario in our view). **In energy, we see near-term escalation in the Middle East being bullish energy, but ultimately assume SoH reopening during 4Q26**, driving an energy price decline and setting the world up for lower inflation, lower US nominal and real rates, lower debt service burdens, and a cyclical upturn in sentiment at least during 2027.

A strengthening Super El Niño is a bullish agricultural commodity market theme into 2027, with markets still underpricing weather-driven supply risks across sugar, robusta coffee, palm oil, rice, and wheat. Overall, the balance of risks remains skewed toward higher food prices, tighter agricultural balances, and further upside in ag commodities if El Niño continues to strengthen. We have raised our grain forecasts to $5.40/$5.90 corn, $7.25/$7.75 wheat, and $12.75/$13.25 soybeans (3M/12M) recently, reflecting tightening supply risks from El Niño, geopolitics, Black Sea disruptions, and biofuel demand. In softs, sugar remains our top bullish call, with targets increased to $0.19/lb (3M) and $0.22/lb (12M), while cocoa moves to neutral after reaching our targets and arabica coffee remains neutral-bearish despite falling inventories, as rising Brazilian exports should ease tightness.

Summer commodities research

- At visible draw rates, when do we "run out" of OIL stockpiles? – This note projects Mar-Jul inventory draws into the future and finds that a status-quo scenario would take until 2028 to see global oil inventories fall to late 1970s levels
- Conflict in the SoH resumes, what does this mean for OIL? – This note features some neat waterfall charts that illustrate why total oil prices collapsed during the MoU, and why there was weakness in crude relative to products prices in particular
- Will IEA/OECD countries release more strategic OIL stocks?
- Super El Niño and Geopolitical Supply Risks Reinforce Our Bullish Ags View and Raise Food Inflation Risks
- Our latest detailed GOLD slides can be found here
- Our latest COPPER slides and outlook can be found here
- Global GAS – Latest views considering the summer rally in TTF

Figure 1. Citi Commodities Research Price Forecasts

			Price Targets								Annual Forecasts			LT Price
		Spot*	0-3M	%chg vs spot	6-12M	%chg vs spot	Q1 2026	Q2 2026E	Q3 2026E	Q4 2026E	2025	2026E	2027E	$2025
Energy														
ICE Brent	USD/bbl	97	**75**	-23%	**70**	-28%	78	97	86	70	68	83	65	70
NYMEX WTI	USD/bbl	92	**71**	-23%	**66**	-29%	73	93	81	66	65	78	61	67
Henry Hub Natural Gas	USD/MMBtu	2.9	**2.8**	-4%	**2.5**	-14%	3.5	2.8	2.9	3.3	3.6	3.1	2.8	3.9
JKM LNG	USD/MMBtu	23.8	**19.2**	-19%	**14.1**	-41%	13.2	17.6	21.0	19.6	12.4	17.9	14.6	6.0
TTF Natural Gas	USD/MMBtu	25.1	**18.7**	-25%	**13.6**	-46%	13.7	15.6	20.4	19.1	12.0	17.2	14.0	5.0
EUA Carbon	EUR/t	83	**85.0**	2%	**90.0**	9%	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	78	90	N/A
Precious Metals														
Gold	USD/t. oz	4506	**4800**	7%	**5000**	11%	4,865	4,510	4,300	4,600	3,443	4,570	5,000	3,600
Silver	USD/t. oz	67.4	**75.0**	11%	**90.0**	34%	83.7	73.1	64.0	70.0	40.1	72.7	80.0	35.0
Platinum	USD/t. oz	1836	**1950**	6%	**2100**	14%	2,202	1,916	1,750	1,900	1,286	1,940	2,000	1,800
Palladium	USD/t. oz	1423	**1500**	5%	**1600**	12%	1,704	1,409	1,325	1,450	1,154	1,470	1,550	1,400
Industrial and Other Metals														
LME Copper	USD/MT	14325	**15000**	5%	**15000**	5%	12,818	13,317	14,250	14,500	9,960	13,700	14,500	11,000
LME Aluminum	USD/MT	3291	**3300**	0%	**3000**	-9%	3,195	3,565	3,250	3,300	2,628	3,350	3,000	3,000
LME Lead	USD/MT	1864	**2000**	7%	**1900**	2%	1,930	1,960	1,850	1,900	1,959	1,910	1,900	2,000
LME Zinc	USD/MT	3941	**4000**	1%	**3600**	-9%	3,235	3,500	3,800	3,800	2,878	3,600	3,650	2,700
LME Nickel	USD/MT	16784	**17000**	1%	**17000**	1%	17,325	18,200	17,000	17,000	15,179	17,400	17,000	17,000
CME Lithium Hydroxide	USD/MT	18400	**23000**	25%	**18000**	-2%	18,200	20,968	19,000	23,000	9,400	20,290	19,750	20,000
Uranium	USD/lb	89	**100**	12%	**110**	23%	86	86	90	100	73	91	131	63
Bulk Commodities														
Iron Ore (TSI)	USD/MT	99	**100**	1%	**90**	-9%	104	106	100	100	102	102	93	85
Thermal Coal (Newc 6K)	USD/MT	147	**150**	2%	**115**	-22%	120	137	130	140	107	132	120	100
Coking Coal (Aus PHCC)	USD/MT	274	**250**	-9%	**220**	-20%	235	238	250	250	188	243	225	200
Agriculture														
CBOT Corn	USd/bu	507	**540**	7%	**590**	16%	460	443	450	525	450	470	570	N/A
CBOT Soybeans	USd/bu	1284	**1275**	-1%	**1325**	3%	1150	1162	1200	1275	1,052	1,197	1,275	N/A
CBOT Wheat	USd/bu	755	**725**	-4%	**775**	3%	550	609	675	725	531	640	744	N/A
ICE Sugar	USd/lb	18.0	**19.0**	5%	**22.0**	22%	14.7	14.3	16.0	19.0	17.1	16.0	20.8	N/A
ICE Coffee	USd/lb	322	**300**	-7%	**275**	-15%	317	283	325	300	371	306	238	N/A
ICE Cocoa	USD/MT	6166	**5000**	-19%	**6000**	-3%	4500	3860	5700	5500	8,182	4,890	6,000	N/A

*Spot as of 09/03/2026

Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

Figure 2. Citi Commodities Research Price Forecast Changes Over the Past Month

		Price Targets		Quarterly Forecast				Annual Forecasts		
		0-3M	6-12M	Q1 2026	Q2 2026E	Q3 2026E	Q4 2026E	2025	2026E	2027E
Energy										
ICE Brent	USD/bbl	0	0	0	0	11	0	0	2	0
NYMEX WTI	USD/bbl	0	0	0	0	10	0	0	2	0
Henry Hub Natural Gas	USD/MMBtu	0	0	0	0	-0.20	0	0	-0.08	0
JKM LNG	USD/MMBtu	3	4.1	0	0	5	5	0	3	4
TTF Natural Gas	USD/MMBtu	3	4.1	0	0	5	5	0	3	4
Precious Metals		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Gold	USD/t. oz	300	0	0	0	50	100	0	40	150
Silver	USD/t. oz	0	0	0	0	-11	-10	0	-5	-5
Platinum	USD/t. oz	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Palladium	USD/t. oz	0	0	0	0	-25	0	0	-10	0
Industrial and Other Metals		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
LME Copper	USD/MT	500	0	0	0	250	0	0	50	250
LME Aluminum	USD/MT	0	-500	0	0	-50	0	0	0	-300
LME Lead	USD/MT	0	-100	0	0	-150	-100	0	-60	-100
LME Zinc	USD/MT	400	300	0	0	200	300	0	150	350
LME Nickel	USD/MT	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CME Lithium Hydroxide	USD/MT	-5000	0	0	0	-6000	-2000	0	-2010	0
Uranium	USD/lb	0	0	0	0	-10	0	0	-2.6	0
Bulk Commodities		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Iron Ore (TSI)	USD/MT	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Thermal Coal (Newc 6K)	USD/MT	25	0	0	0	5.3	10	0	3.7	0
Coking Coal (Aus PHCC)	USD/MT	30	0	0	0	30	20	0	12	0
Agriculture		0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
CBOT Corn	USd/bu	40	40	0	0	-50	25	0	6	26
CBOT Soybeans	USd/bu	25	25	0	0	-50	25	0	-16	0
CBOT Wheat	USd/bu	25	25	0	0	-25	25	0	-10	6
ICE Sugar	USd/lb	2	3	0	0	-1	0	0	-0.3	2.8
ICE Coffee	USd/lb	50	50	0	0	25	25	0	12	13
ICE Cocoa	USD/MT	0	0	0	0	1200	500	0	390	0

Source: Citi Research

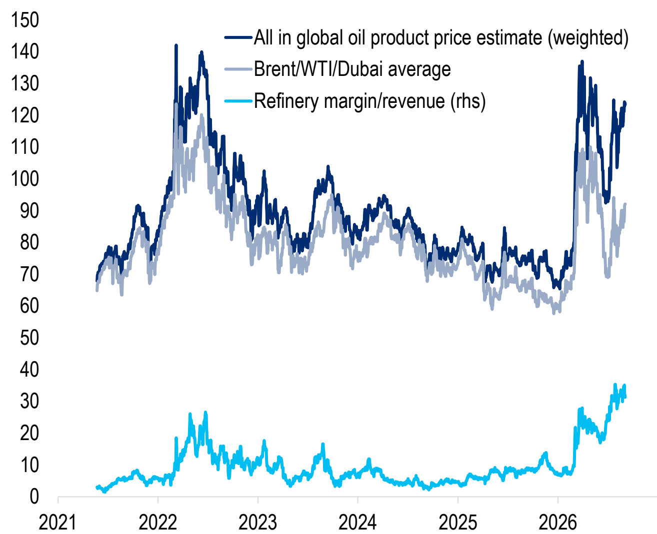
Energy – Geopolitics driving a large deficit; structural surplus reappears on SoH reopening

Oil

We see the current situation (US blockade, sizable Oman SoH flows) as unsustainable, with the Iranian regime saying it will escalate imminently if the US does not return to the MoU. We believe that Iran is incentivized to try to break the blockade sooner rather than later, with its economy suffering from a dramatic decline in its currency and lost oil revenues in recent weeks. On the US side, we believe the situation is unsustainable because eventually higher oil prices are likely to negatively affect equity and/or bond markets, to which we believe the administration is sensitive. The November midterms (three months away), as they come closer, may be a catalyst for President Trump to deal, or soften the blockade at least temporarily; however, we think President Trump will not likely stop his current course due to the midterms alone (given the White House seems unlikely to get major policy changes through the House anyway).

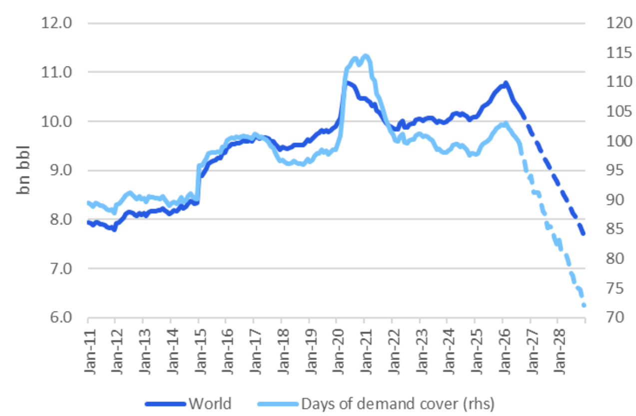
As such, our central scenario is a near-term escalation in the Middle East that eventually results in another major attempt at dealmaking, or that other factors change (belligerent leadership changes for example, or regional deals emerge) such that the SoH reopens during 4Q26. The SoH has taken longer than our prior assumption and we mark-to-market our 3Q26 Brent forecast higher to $86/bbl as a result, while maintaining $70/bbl for 4Q26 and $65/bbl for 2027, since a reopening of the Strait should lead to oil returning to an even larger surplus than pre-conflict (~3–4mb/d vs ~2mb/d prior). Oil products markets are bearing the brunt of the global shortage of oil, and we expect a reopening of the SoH to see them get crushed, albeit not all the way to pre-conflict levels for 3-6 months.

Figure 3. All-in oil/product prices are above $120/bbl (dark blue line), similar to 2022; however, the breakdown is different, with refinery margins much higher (light blue) and crude lower (grey)



Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

Figure 4. World total oil/products inventories would take until 2028 to reach levels consistent with the 2nd oil shock of the 1970s on their Feb–Jul 2026 trajectory (status quo)

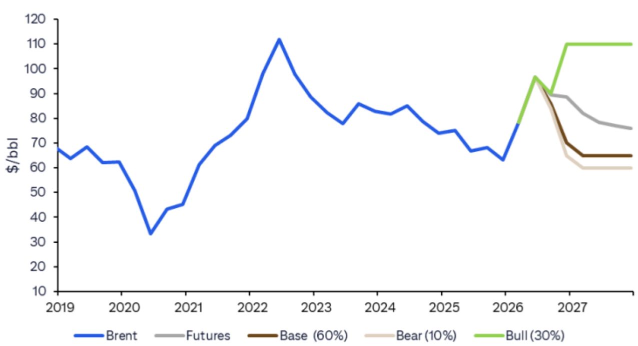


Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

Of course, there are more bullish oil price scenarios than this, including a status quo / sustained SoH disruption scenario (20–25% indicative probability), and a mutual energy infrastructure destruction scenario (5–10%). A sustained war disrupting flows from the Middle East, without major energy infrastructure damage, is the main alternative scenario we present (represented by our bull case of 30%), and we find it would result in gradually higher oil prices over the coming year, say to $110–120/bbl average Brent (we find it would take ~2 years, i.e., until 2028, to see inventories decline to late-1970s levels, where oil prices represented 7–8% of world GDP, compared to 4% today and 2% at the beginning of this year) .

Mutual energy infrastructure destruction would bring this forward and lock the bull scenario in, in our view. We assign only a low probability to mutual energy infrastructure destruction since Iran does not want its public and energy infrastructure destroyed (potentially raising the chances of regime change), given Iran's ally China is more economically exposed to other Middle East nations than to Iran (5–8x on various FDI and trade metrics), and since we note that the US and China likely both want to avoid a 1970s-style oil shock to deal with.

Figure 5. Citi oil price forecasts, including central case scenario, bull and bear scenarios



Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

Figure 6. Citi oil price forecasts, including central case scenario, bull and bear scenarios

Citi Oil Price Deck	Short term target		Quarterly Forecasts				Annual Forecasts	
	0-3M	6-12M	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	4Q26	2026F	2027F
Brent Base Case (Prob. 60%)	75	70	78	97	86	70	83	65
Brent Futures	96		78	97	89	89	88	78
Brent Base Case vs. Futures	-22%		0%	0%	-4%	-21%	-6%	-17%
Brent Bull Case (Prob. 30%)	110		78	97	90	110	94	110
Brent Bull Case vs. Futures	14%		0%	0%	1%	24%	6%	40%
Brent Bear Case (Prob. 10%)	65		78	97	84	65	81	60
WTI	71	66	73	93	81	66	78	61
WTI Futures	92		73	93	84	84	84	73
WTI vs. Futures	-23%		0%	0%	-4%	-22%	-6%	-17%
Brent -WTI	4	4	6	5	5	4	5	4

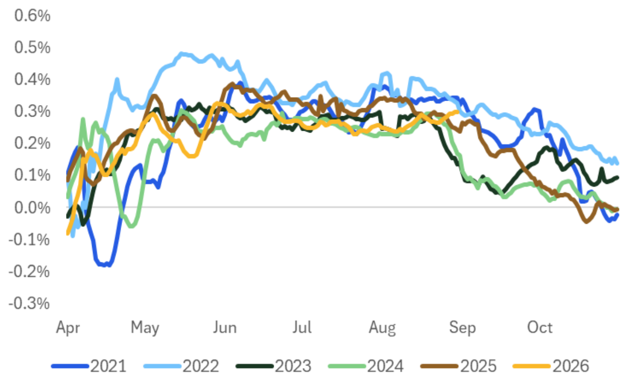
As of 09/03/2026

Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

Gas

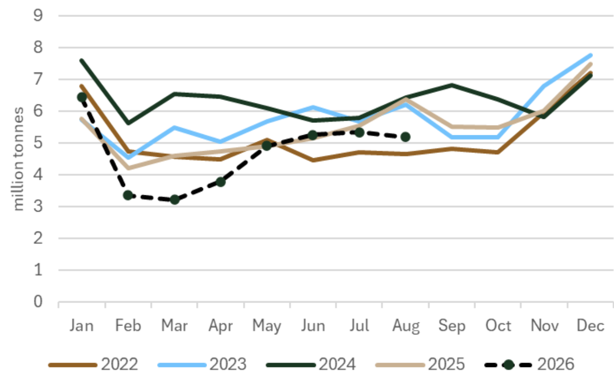
For global natural gas, we lower 3Q26 prices of US Henry Hub to $2.9/MMBtu on expectation of production growth, and raise TTF prices higher to €60/MWh for 3Q26 and €56/MWh for 4Q26 as the market continues to expect the Strait to be severely disrupted for LNG exports. The pricing divergence between US Henry Hub and global benchmarks such as Asian JKM LNG and European TTF natural gas could not be more stark. Although LNG supply is not large enough yet to bring about a convergence in US and global prices, JKM and TTF prices have risen but US Henry Hub winter prices have fallen, despite confronting a likely (or more than two-thirds chance of a mild winter in both Asia and the US due to the Super El Nino. It seems that the fear of prolonged geopolitical disruptions of Middle Eastern LNG exports exacerbates the worry posed by lower European gas storage. Nonetheless, if weather-adjusted European winter demand is ~15% lower vs. before the Russia-Ukraine war, then the current projection of ~72% full in Oct'26 storage is equivalent to ~85% full in the pre-war market. Thus, projected European storage does not look as low as the market is concerned about, in our view. We expect Oct'27 storage to reach ~74% full assuming normal weather.

Figure 7. European natural gas injections have held at elevated levels in recent weeks, based on the rolling 7-day average



Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

Figure 8. China's LNG imports likely fell by around 20% YoY in August

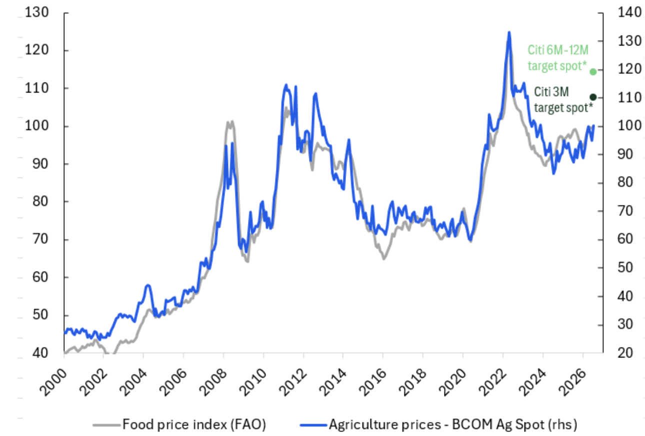


Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

Super El Niño and Geopolitical Supply Risks Reinforce Our Bullish Ags View and Raise Food Inflation Risks

A strengthening Super El Niño remains our highest-conviction agricultural risk heading into late 2026 and early 2027. NOAA now assigns a greater than 90% probability of a very strong event and a 69% probability that the event exceeds the strength of all El Niño episodes since 1950 during October-December (NOAA, August 2026 update). Based on our new Production-at-Risk (PAR) framework, current market pricing appears to reflect only a portion of the potential downside risks to global agricultural production. The largest weather-exposed commodities remain palm oil, robusta coffee, rice, sugar, cocoa, and Australian wheat, while risks are concentrated geographically across Australia, India, Southeast Asia, and parts of Brazil. Importantly, production revisions since March 2026 remain significantly smaller than our estimated PAR metrics, suggesting additional downside risks to global supply estimates if El Niño continues to strengthen. While Argentina is likely to benefit from improved rainfall, we believe risks to global agricultural production remain skewed to the upside for prices.

Figure 9. Food prices are rising, with traded agricultural prices up more than 20% YTD on worsening El Nino prospects



Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

Figure 10. Agricultural production at risk on the back of strong El Niño

Commodity	Revision Since Mar-26*	Revision Since Jul-26**	Global Production-at-Risk***	Risk Level
Palm Oil	▼ -2.5%	▼ -0.8%	-5% to -8%	Very High
Rice	▼ -1.5%	▼ -0.3%	-2% to -4%	Very High
Robusta Coffee	▼ -4.0%	▼ -1.5%	-3% to -6%	Very High
Arabica Coffee	▼ -1.5%	▼ -0.4%	-1% to -3%	High
Sugar	▼ -2.0%	▼ -0.7%	-2% to -5%	Very High
Cocoa	▼ -1.0%	▼ -0.2%	-1% to -4%	High
Wheat	▼ -1.2%	▼ -0.1%	-1% to -3%	High
Cotton	▼ -1.0%	▼ -0.2%	-1% to -3%	High
Corn	▼ -0.5%	0	-0.5% to -2.0%	Medium
Canola	▼ -0.4%	0	-0.5% to -2.0%	Medium
Soybeans	▲ +0.3%	▲ +0.1%	-1% to +2%	Neutral/Mixed
Barley	▼ -0.8%	▼ -0.1%	-1% to -2%	Medium

* Development of El Niño was first announced in March. Revisions in global production are compared versus previous estimates by official agencies
** Revisions since last month
*** Global Production-at-Risk is the sum of (Country Production Share× Yield Beta to ENSO× ENSO Probability× Stage Sensitivity× Crop Calendar Severity). Estimations are based on historical moderate to strong El Nino episodes.

Source: Citi Research, USDA, NOAA, ICO, ISO, ICCO, Expana

CBOT Grains/Oilseeds: Trade flows, disruptions in Black Sea ports, and poor weather all point to higher prices

Prices of corn, wheat, and soybeans have reached our near-term targets, and we now expect corn to reach $5.4/bu, wheat $7.25/bu, and soybeans $12.75/bu over the next three months. Over a 12-month horizon, we expect corn prices to reach $5.90/bu, wheat $7.75/bu, and soybean $13.25/bu. A number of unrelated bullish risks are actively developing for the grains/oilseeds complex, which in our view could manifest in a real storm if all of those risks materialize. Those risks **include trade, ongoing conflicts, weather (El Niño), and biofuel demand**.

While risks remain firmly skewed to the bullish side for grains and oilseeds over the near term. That said, several factors could prevent a more pronounced rally. (1) US corn and soybean supplies are still projected to remain near historically high levels despite recent yield revisions. (2) We believe Black Sea trade flows could partially normalize over the coming months. (3) Weather remains the largest wildcard in our outlook. While a strengthening El Niño raises the probability of production losses across several key agricultural regions, weather outcomes are inherently difficult to predict and could ultimately result in either materially tighter or more comfortable global balances. (4) Finally, our bullish view assumes that China broadly honors its agricultural import commitments. A deterioration in trade relations or a decision by China to scale back purchases could result in a meaningful reduction in US export demand.

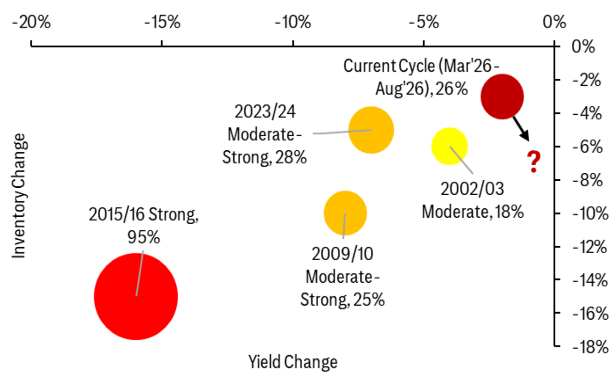
Nevertheless, when weighing the potential downside risks against the combination of El Niño-related supply threats, Black Sea uncertainty, tightening vegetable oil balances, and expanding global biofuel demand, we believe the balance of risks continues to favor higher grain and oilseed prices over the next 6–12 months.

Related Research: [Global Commodities - Super El Niño and Geopolitical Supply Risks Reinforce Our Bullish Ags View and Raise Food Inflation Risks]

We are bullish sugar, neutral cocoa, neutral-bearish arabica coffee from current levels

Historical evidence suggests that inventory conditions, rather than yield losses alone, have been the primary determinant of price performance during El Niño episodes. While sugar and robusta coffee have consistently exhibited the greatest production sensitivity to El Niño-related weather disruptions, the largest rallies have occurred when adverse weather coincided with already depleted inventories. Cocoa's exceptional 2023/24 rally illustrates this dynamic clearly, as severe West African crop losses were amplified by a roughly 30% collapse in inventories, triggering an unprecedented price response**. Looking at the current cycle, sugar and robusta coffee appear most vulnerable, combining elevated weather exposure with relatively thin inventory cushions, while cocoa enters this El Niño event with a more comfortable stock position than in 2023/24.** Overall, history suggests that investors should focus less on headline weather forecasts and more on whether inventory buffers are sufficient to absorb potential production shortfalls, as this has proven to be the key driver of price volatility across the soft commodities complex.

Figure 11. Current El Niño Cycle vs Historical Episodes: Sugar is exposed the most to El Niño while yields and inventories are yet to decline*, **

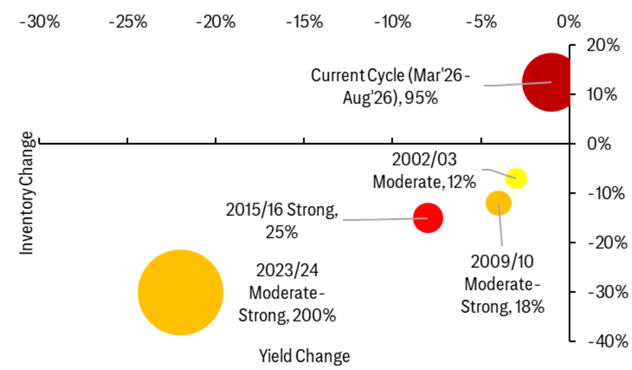


*Size of the bubble represents the previous price performance of each commodity

** Inventory, yield, and price changes are estimated for the period between the moment El Niño officially announced start and end dates

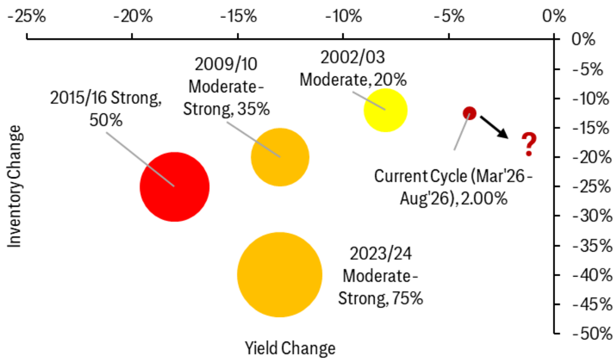
Source: Citi Research, Expana, Bloomberg

Figure 12. Current El Niño Cycle vs Historical Episodes: Cocoa inventory levels have been improving, while price appreciated significantly



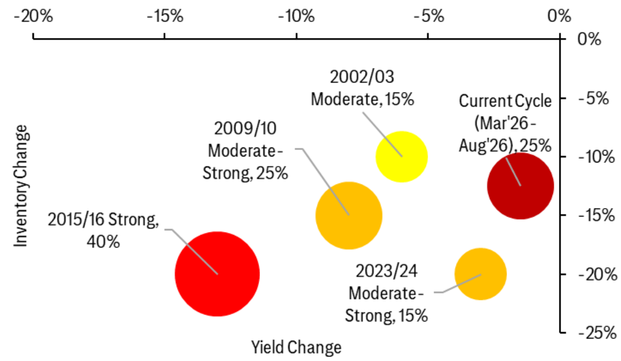
Source: Citi Research, Expana, Bloomberg

Figure 13. Current El Niño Cycle vs Historical Episodes: Robusta coffee could represent a good opportunity as prices have not appreciated yet



Source: Citi Research, Expana, Bloomberg

Figure 14. Current El Niño Cycle vs Historical Episodes: Arabica coffee inventories are extremely low, while production is set to improve on the back of higher prices



Source: Citi Research, Expana, Bloomberg

We remain tactically bullish on SUGAR and revised our price target to $0.19/lb (+4% vs spot) as previous target of $0.17/lb was breached for 3 months. In 12 months, we now expect prices to reach $0.22/lb (+21% vs spot). We closed our long call spread idea for 58% profit, while price continued to rise. In India, the weather has been unfavorable, and even though it has rained, it still was well below average.

COCOA prices reached our targets of $5k in 3 months and $6k/t (-2% vs spot) in 12 months. We will shift neutral and keep current price forecast unchanged, as we think prices retraced quicker than we expected. While we think prices will stay elevated for some time, we still would need to see more evidence on El Niño impacts on crop yields and stronger grindings data as we expect it. It has been raining above normal in Ecuador and relatively dry, with very little precipitation levels in Ivory Coast. If such trends continue into mid to late September, our supply outlook will be significantly cut. We had a profitable trade in cocoa with 161% profit level, and will be on the sidelines for now.

COFFEE inventories continue to decline rapidly, suggesting that global consumption may be significantly underestimated. Our broader outlook remains bearish, while we revise up our 3-month price target to $3/lb (–12% vs spot) and $2.75/lb in 12 months (–19% vs spot). We continue to expect downside pressure on arabica prices as Brazilian exports are likely to increase meaningfully beginning in September, helping to rebuild depleted inventories and ease supply tightness.

Related Research: Global Commodities – ICE Softs Outlook: Weather Risks Intensify Across Softs, with Sugar Remaining Our Highest-Conviction Bullish View

Precious Metals

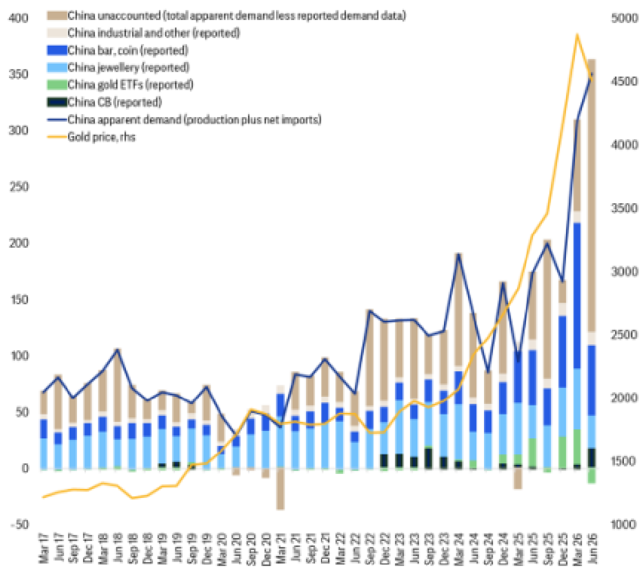
We remain bullish precious metals, with our 0–3-month point price target for gold at $4,800/oz and 6–12-month forecast at $5,000/oz (vs ~$4,500/oz spot), and for silver at $75/oz (vs $67/oz spot). In our latest gold update, we highlighted the binary risks around Jackson Hole and the fragility of the August rally which was spec/paper-driven with a lack of physical demand follow-through. Indeed, gold prices were hit by the hawkish Warsh speech last Friday, which in our view presented dip-buying opportunities. Key technical support levels to watch include the 100dMA (~$4,366/oz) and 50dMA ($4,218/oz), while ~$4k/oz has proved to be a solid support level amid weak July trading (China and UHNW buying helped gold put in the lows, and Treasury purchases of the yen and the US long end drove it up).

Our central scenario is that flows improve through the SoH during 4Q26 and that resulting lower oil prices (see the oil section) will see a strong rally in gold via multiple channels:

1) Easing the inflationary pressure, which contributes to a more dovish Fed, lower US real rates, and a weaker dollar, boosting investment demand for gold; and
2) Relieving the fiscal burden and currency depreciation pressure for EM markets (e.g., India), which will likely lead to loosening of import controls/duties on precious metals and boosting physical demand. We expect silver and PGMs to continue to track gold prices in direction albeit with high beta.
3) Momentum in gold prices will likely attract retail buying similar to 2H25—both physical and futures globally. Retail participants have for the most part not participated in the summer rebound in gold prices and have the potential to take gold back to its February highs when they start buying again. Note: Futures trading involves substantial risk of loss.

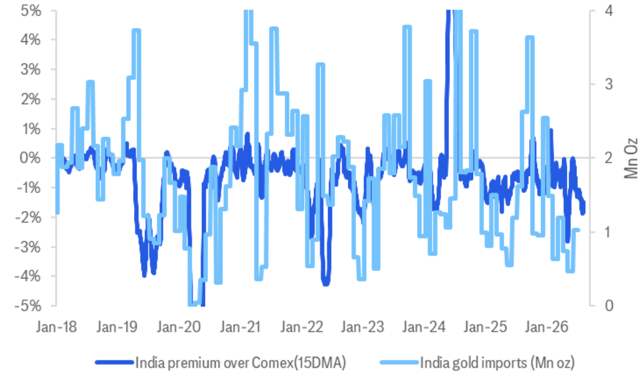
We also believe gold can be resilient to a prolonged SoH closure, as it has proven to be since the MoU between the US and Iran collapsed over a month ago. This makes the risk skew on gold tilted towards the upside, with the biggest fear being a major risk off in equities that results in a temporary sell-off.

Figure 15. China buying has remained strong and picked up overall when prices dipped to $4k/oz



Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

Figure 16. India's gold premium (ex-duty) remains negative, but a return to buying over the coming months should support the gold bull market



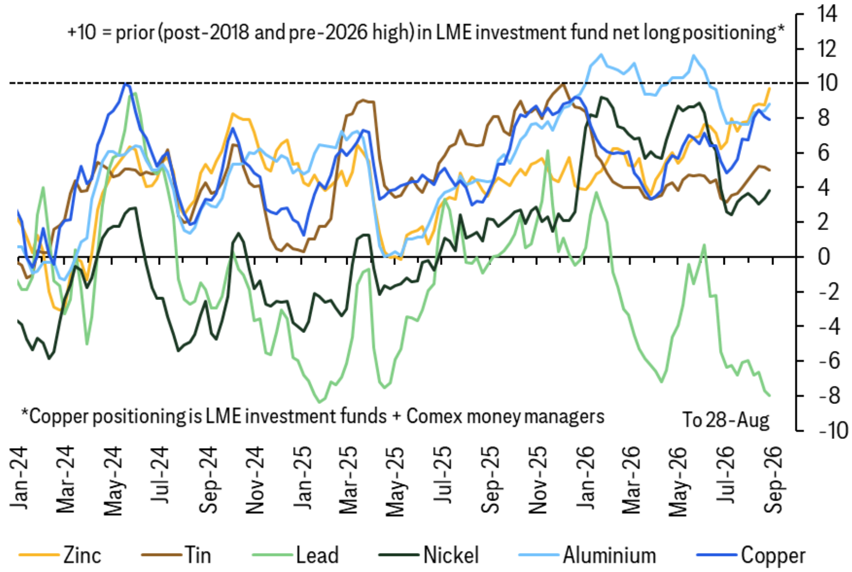
Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

Industrial Metals

We remain constructive on industrial metals over the next 12 months (copper to $15k/t, tin to $60k/t, neutral others). Aluminium remains more nuanced, in our view. We remain neutral to constructive near-term given low visible inventories and a still-tight physical market, though the balance becomes more challenging over the next 6–12 months as ex-China supply growth accelerates. Nevertheless, we do not expect prices to sustain materially below $3,000/t and become increasingly bullish into 2029–30 as deficits re-emerge.

Structural demand from the energy transition and AI (plus future potential from military and robotics) and constrained supply are common drivers underpinning physical metal market resilience, despite tepid cyclical end-use consumption growth so far this year. The complex overall remains leveraged to any improvement in soft cyclical growth expectations, with a further bullish skew of tail risks from potential strategic mineral stockpiling or resurgent debasement fears. Investor net long positioning and pricing across key metals are already relatively elevated, so further price gains are most likely to be gradual without fresh physical market catalysts.

Figure 17. Aluminium, copper, and zinc investor net long positioning is close to pre-2026 highs



Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

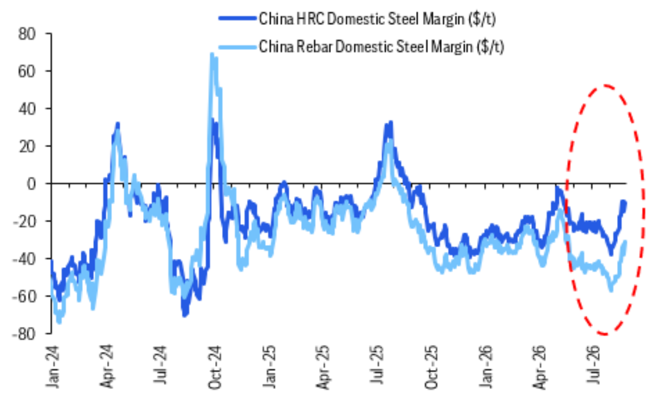
We update our price forecast scenarios for industrial metals in the table below. Base metal prices have generally performed as anticipated over the last few months as supply issues offset ongoing weakness in cyclical end-use consumption. Zinc has surprised most here, with ex-China pricing elevated on a wide and negative China arbitrage and elevated mine supply disruption that have underpinned concentrate market tightness. We revise our zinc prices higher to mark-to-market this reality accordingly, while remaining neutral near-term given stretched positioning and the market's reliance on mine supply constraints to support these higher price levels which we see easing into 2027.

Bulks

Iron ore: We expect iron ore prices to remain rangebound at $95-100/t in the near term and maintain our 0–3-month price target of $100/t. Prices have rallied ~7% since early August, supported by seasonal steel mill restocking ahead of the peak demand season, opportunistic end-user buying, and firmer freight rates that have lifted the marginal cost floor. However, we view the risk-reward as balanced and would not chase the rally absent meaningful policy stimulus from China. Ongoing weakness in steel end-use demand, higher coking coal and coke costs that are squeezing mill margins, and elevated iron ore inventories at Chinese ports should cap further upside.

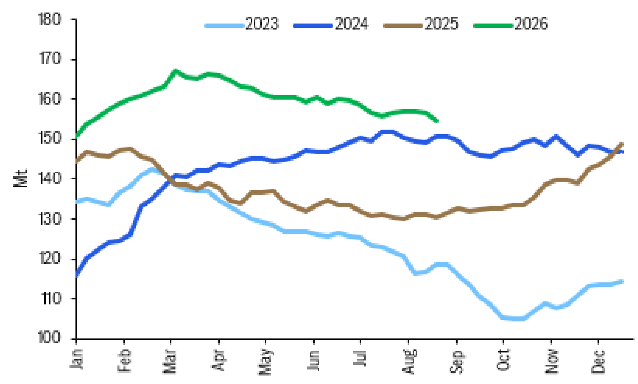
[Global Diversified Metals & Mining: Iron ore producer breakevens are rising, with cost support emerging at $85/t]

Figure 18. Weak end-use demand and coke price inflation to weigh on steel margins



Source: Citi Research, S&P Global Platts

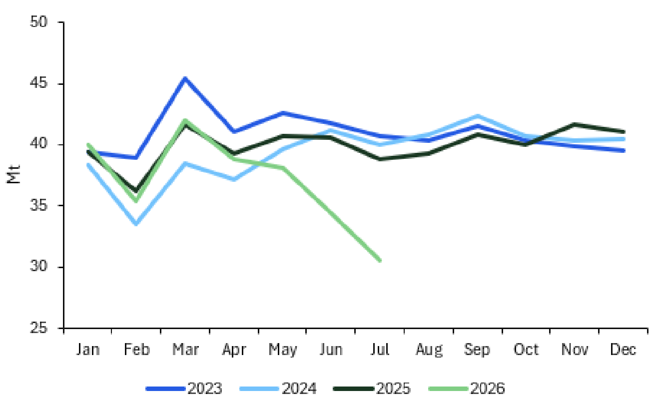
Figure 19. Ample iron ore port inventories likely to cap price upside



Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

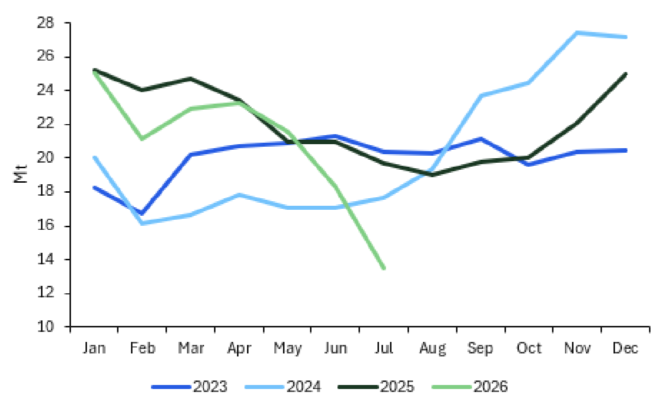
Coking coal: Tightness in Chinese domestic supply has underpinned seaborne coking coal prices, prompting us to raise our 0–3-month price target to $250/t (vs $220/t). Australian FOB prices have risen by $55/t over the past two weeks as supply concerns in China triggered precautionary stock-building by traders and steel mills. A series of mining accidents has heightened expectations of stricter safety inspections, while the pace of production recovery following the Shanxi mine accident (Bloomberg, May 2026) has remained disappointing. Additional concerns over diesel availability in Mongolia and weather-related coke production disruptions in Indonesia have further tightened regional supply. With seaborne cargoes still trading at a meaningful discount to domestic Chinese prices, end-users have stepped up imports, providing support to FOB prices. While we expect prices to remain elevated in the near term, we remain cautious on the outlook as weak steel end-use demand and compressed mill margins are likely to cap further upside.

Figure 20. China mine accidents/safety inspections have impacted domestic coking coal supply...



Source: Citi Research, SXCoal

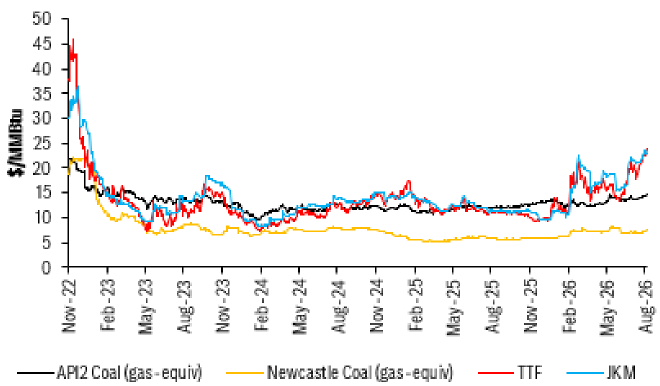
Figure 21. ...leading to drawdown of coking coal inventories in China



Source: Citi Research, SXCoal

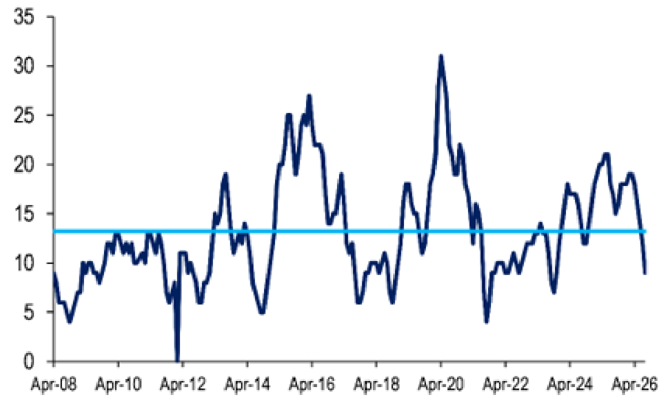
Thermal coal: We raise our 0–3-month Newcastle 6,000 kcal/kg price target to US$150/t (from US$125/t), supported by winter restocking demand and heightened geopolitical risk premiums. Supply-side uncertainty and firmer freight rates should continue to provide downside support. Thermal coal prices have remained elevated through 3Q26, driven by a combination of weather-related disruptions and geopolitical tensions. Escalating Middle East tensions have lifted LNG prices, improving the economics of fuel switching towards thermal coal. In Europe, low river levels and reduced hydro availability have curtailed nuclear generation, further supporting coal burn. Meanwhile, diesel shortages stemming from Russian refinery outages have constrained Russian thermal coal availability. In India, thermal coal demand strengthened in August 2026 as a weak monsoon boosted power demand. Power plant coal inventories have declined to 31Mt, and despite ample national coal stocks, logistical bottlenecks continue to constrain deliveries to end-users.

Figure 22. Fuel switching economics remains attractive for thermal coal



Source: Citi Research, Bloomberg

Figure 23. Days of coal inventory at Indian power plants at 9 days of consumption (lowest in 3 years)

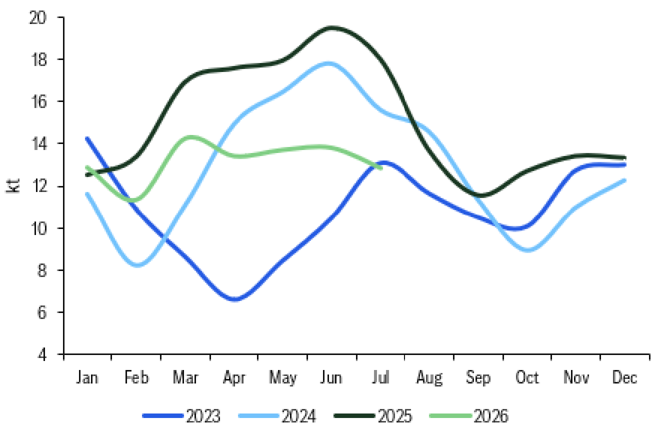


Source: Citi Research, CEA

Battery Metals

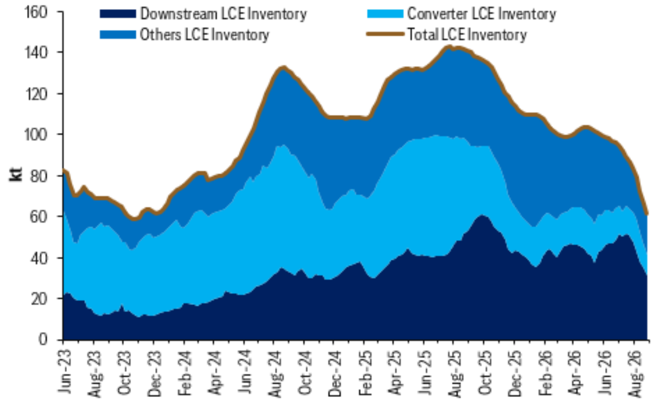
Lithium: We are constructive on lithium in the near term as restocking of battery supply chain ahead of traditional season combined with tight supply is likely to drive prices higher. Our new 0–3-month point price forecasts for lithium carbonate, hydroxide, and spodumene (SC6) is $30k/t, $23k/t, and $3k/t. However, improved supply into next year is likely to keep prices under pressure in 2027. Chinese lithium carbonate prices have largely traded range-bound at US$20,000–22,000/t through most of 3Q26, as uncertainty surrounding the restart of the Jianxiawo (JXW) mine, which accounts for roughly 4–5% of global LCE supply, capped upside despite a fundamentally tight market. Prices have rallied in recent days after Yichun City Council withdrew its environmental impact assessment (EIA) notice for JXW (Asian Metal, Aug'26), indicating the mine is unlikely to restart in the near term. Strong battery production demand, low visible inventories, and tightening feedstock availability continue to underpin prices. However, we see improved supply into next year combined with a mixed cell outlook to weigh on prices. We mark to market our 3Q'26 forecasts and revise our 4Q'26 and CY'27 forecasts.

Figure 24. PRC's lepidolite production ramp up remains challenging



Source: Citi Research, SMM

Figure 25. Visible inventories of lithium chemicals remain low (~15 days of consumption)



Source: Citi Research, SMM

Commodities QIS Strategies

The commodities QIS space has seen many new product innovations in recent years. We believe further innovation could be made in the following ways. Term structure / backwardation strategies could benefit from using interest rate adjusted spread signals instead of simple contango/backwardation signals. Rising or falling interest rate environments can obscure the fundamental signal given by curve structure, and adjusting for this may improve returns. Further, removing extreme signals is also likely to improve returns, by avoiding going long super backwardations (which can kill demand and create supply), or super contangos (which can kill supply and create demand), negatively impacting returns. Momentum strategies are highly likely to benefit from a skewness overlay, with skewness essentially providing a broad beta signal (according to recent academic literature) confirming or denying to momentum signal. We are very encouraged by this and view it as potentially a pivotal strategy, where drawdown limits of 5–10% are applied. Our preliminary work suggests the strategy would have worked very well over the past 25 years for BCOM, oil, gold, and copper. Momentum strategies that trim winners too much could perhaps adjust adjusted vol^0.5 instead of just vol, without negatively impacting the Sharpe ratio. Note: Futures trading involves substantial risk of loss.

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Appendix A-1

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